

AFRIVATE LEAVE AND ABSENCE POLICY

Document Code	AFRI-LAP-01
Target Audience	All Staff & Volunteers
Policy Owner	People & Culture (HR)
Status	Mandatory Compliance

1. PURPOSE

This Policy establishes a clear and consistent process for requesting leave from AfriVate Technologies Ltd. It is designed to protect employee wellbeing while ensuring continuity, accountability, and uninterrupted team delivery.

2. NOTICE REQUIREMENT

Except in an accepted emergency, every leave request must be submitted at least **three (3) official work days** before the first intended day of absence. Official work days are the days recognised by AfriVate as scheduled working days and do not include weekends, public holidays, or company-declared non-working days.

Important: Submitting a request does not constitute approval. Staff must remain available for work until the request has been formally approved through the portal.

3. WORK COMPLETION & HANDOVER

Before proceeding on approved leave, the requesting team member must protect the continuity of their work. They are required to:

- **Complete outstanding work:** Round up all due or outstanding work for the relevant week before the leave begins; or
- **Arrange reassignment:** Where completion is not reasonably possible, agree with the Team Lead to reassign the work to an appropriate colleague;
- **Provide a clear handover:** Share the status, deadlines, files, access information, and next actions needed by the colleague taking over; and
- **Confirm ownership:** Ensure the Team Lead and receiving colleague understand and accept the temporary arrangement.

Leave may be delayed or declined where an adequate handover has not been completed and business continuity would be materially affected.

4. REASON & APPROVAL

Every request must include a clear and truthful reason, the requested dates, and any relevant supporting information. The People & Culture (HR) team retains the authority to **approve or decline** a leave request after considering:

- The reason and urgency of the request;
- The notice provided;
- The employee's handover and outstanding responsibilities;
- Team capacity and operational requirements; and
- The employee's recent leave and attendance record.

HR may consult the relevant Team Lead before making a decision. Where reasonable and appropriate, HR will communicate the reason for a declined request.

5. OFFICIAL SUBMISSION CHANNEL

All leave requests must be made through the **AfriVate Portal**. Requests made only through WhatsApp, email, telephone, or verbal conversation are not official and will not be treated as approved leave.

1. Sign in to the AfriVate Portal.
2. Open the Leave section and select the applicable leave type.
3. Enter the dates and a clear reason for the request.
4. Add handover details and supporting documentation where required.
5. Submit the request and await the decision recorded in the portal.

6. EMERGENCY & IMPROMPTU LEAVE

AfriVate recognises that an accepted emergency may make the required three official work days' notice impossible. Emergency consideration is limited to:

- **Medical emergencies:** An urgent illness, injury, hospital admission, or immediate medical situation affecting the team member or a person under their direct care.
- **Specified personal emergencies:** A serious, unforeseen personal event that requires the team member's immediate presence. The specific circumstances must be clearly stated in the portal request and may require reasonable supporting information.

In either case, the team member must notify their Team Lead and HR as soon as reasonably possible and submit or regularise the request through the portal at the earliest opportunity.

An emergency exception is not an automatic approval and must not be used to avoid the standard notice and handover requirements.

7. REPEATED IMPROMPTU LEAVE & CONSEQUENCES

Consistent impromptu leave, repeated late requests, unauthorised absence, or misuse of the emergency exception may attract corrective or disciplinary action. Depending on frequency, impact, and surrounding circumstances, action may include:

- A documented discussion or coaching;
- A verbal or written warning;
- Restriction or closer review of future discretionary leave requests; or
- Further action under AfriVate's progressive discipline process.

Any consequence will be considered fairly, with regard to the employee's explanation, supporting evidence, attendance history, and applicable company policy.

8. RESPONSIBILITIES

- **Team Members:** Submit timely and accurate requests, complete or hand over work, and wait for formal approval.
- **Team Leads:** Assess delivery impact, support handover arrangements, and provide HR with an objective operational recommendation.
- **People & Culture (HR):** Review requests consistently, record decisions through the portal, and maintain appropriate leave records.

Policy standard: No leave is approved until the decision appears in the AfriVate Portal. Medical emergencies and clearly specified personal emergencies will be considered with fairness, but repeated avoidable non-compliance may attract a penalty under the progressive discipline process.